LIGHTHOUSE CHURCH TULUM

what to do in tulum

Beaches, cenotes, ruins, good food and practical tips, put together by your church family here in Tulum.

A VISITOR GUIDE FROM LIGHTHOUSE CHURCH TULUM

01 · ESSENTIALS

know before you go

Money

- Carry **pesos in cash**. Cenotes, taco stands and colectivos rarely take cards.
- Use ATMs **inside banks** and choose "decline conversion" so you're charged in pesos.
- Beach-zone prices are often 2–3× what you'll pay in town.

Getting around

- **Bike**: the easiest way between town and the beach, and there's a bike path.
- **Taxi**: agree on the price *before* you get in.
- **Colectivos** (white vans) on Hwy 307 go cheaply to Akumal, Playa del Carmen and nearby cenotes.
- Arriving: Tulum airport (TQO), Cancún (CUN), the ADO bus station downtown, or the Tren Maya.

Sun & water

- Use **biodegradable/reef-safe sunscreen**. Most cenotes require it, or ask you to rinse off.
- Drink only bottled or purified water.
- Watch the beach flags: **green** safe, **yellow** caution, **red** stay out.

Seaweed & safety

- **Sargassum** (seaweed) is worst roughly April–September. Check a sargassum report before planning a beach day.
- Emergencies: **911**.
- Keep valuables out of sight on the beach and in cars.

02 · BEACHES

public beaches

All beaches in Mexico are public by law. These are the easiest places to get onto the sand without paying a beach club.

FREE

Playa Pescadores

Fishing boats, calm-ish water and a local feel, at the start of the hotel zone. Easy to reach by bike. Restaurants nearby.

INSIDE PARQUE DEL JAGUAR

Playa Santa Fe / Playa Ruinas

Turquoise water right below the Mayan ruins. Rustic, with few services. Access can close when the surf is high.

INSIDE PARQUE DEL JAGUAR

Playa Paraíso

The postcard beach: white sand and palm trees. Go early to avoid crowds. Bring water and shade.

FREE

Playa Las Palmas

Quiet stretch south of the hotel zone with informal parking and no services. Pack in what you need and pack out your trash.

Tip: Parking near the beaches is very limited, and drivers are often steered into paid beach-club lots. A bike or taxi is easier. Many beach clubs also offer free entry or a minimum spend, so ask before you sit down.

03 · HISTORY

ruins & jaguar park

Tulum's clifftop Mayan city sits inside the new Parque del Jaguar, which also has bike paths and beach access. Go at

opening time: it's cooler and much quieter.

ENTRY (FROM JULY 20, 2026)	FOREIGN VISITORS	MEXICAN VISITORS
Parque del Jaguar	$100 MXN	Free
National Park + Archaeological Zone (ruins)	$165 MXN	$80 MXN (Mon–Sat)

Tulum residents with proof of address get in free. On **Sundays**, Mexican citizens and foreign residents of Mexico enter the ruins free. Children, seniors and people with disabilities are also exempt. Fees change, so bring cash and check at the gate.

04 · SWIM

cenotes

Cenotes are freshwater swimming holes in limestone caves, with crystal-clear water, and they're a must in Tulum. Expect roughly $150–500 MXN entry, cash only. Life jackets and lockers usually cost extra. Several of the best are on the **Tulum–Cobá road**, the same road as our church.

COBÁ ROAD · NEAR CHURCH

Gran Cenote

The classic: turtles, caverns and great snorkeling. Very popular, so arrive at opening (around 8 am).

COBÁ ROAD · NEAR CHURCH

Cenote Calavera

The "skull" cenote: three holes in the ground and a jump into the water below. Small, fun and cheaper.

COBÁ ROAD

Zacil-Ha & Car Wash (Aktun Ha)

Laid-back open-air cenotes, good for families and an easy swim.

HWY 307 NORTH

Dos Ojos

World-famous cave system for snorkeling and diving. A guided tour is worth it.

TANKAH BAY

Casa Cenote

A mangrove-lined cenote that flows to the sea, just north of Tulum. Gentle and great for kids.

HWY 307 NORTH

Cenote Azul & Jardín del Edén

Big, sunny open cenotes with cliff jumps, between Tulum and Playa del Carmen.

05 · EAT

where to eat

Eat in town (*el pueblo*) for real flavor at local prices. Three tacos in town often cost what one costs on the beach.

TACOS · DINNER

Antojitos La Chiapaneca

A local favorite for tacos al pastor and salbutes. Evenings only, cash only, standing room.

BREAKFAST · LUNCH

Taquería Honorio

Yucatecan cochinita pibil and lechón tacos. Opens early and often sells out by early afternoon.

TACOS · GRILL

El Asadero

Grilled-meat tacos and plates, consistently rated among the best value in town.

SEAFOOD

El Camello Jr.

No-frills seafood spot on the main avenue, known for huge ceviches and fish tacos.

SEAFOOD

Los Aguachiles

Lively seafood cantina with aguachiles, tostadas and shrimp tacos.

COFFEE · BREAKFAST

Don Cafeto & Burrito Amor

Easy, reliable picks downtown: classic Mexican breakfasts at Don Cafeto, and big burritos and smoothies at Burrito Amor.

SPECIAL NIGHT OUT

Hartwood (beach road)

Famous wood-fired restaurant in the hotel zone. Book ahead.

TREAT

Marquesitas & elotes

Look for evening street carts in the town square: crispy rolled marquesitas and corn on the cob.

06 · EXPLORE

day trips

45 MIN · COBÁ ROAD

Cobá

A huge Mayan city in the jungle. Rent a bike or pedicab to reach the pyramid, and stop at cenotes on the way.

25 MIN NORTH

Akumal

Snorkel with sea turtles in the bay. Go with a certified guide and keep your distance from the turtles.

SOUTH

Sian Ka'an & Muyil

A UNESCO biosphere with lagoons, dolphins, birds and floating canals. Combine it with the small, peaceful Muyil ruins.

2–2.5 HRS

Bacalar

The "lagoon of seven colors." Stay overnight if you can.

1.5–2 HRS

Valladolid & Chichén Itzá

A colorful colonial town and a wonder of the world. Arrive at Chichén Itzá at opening time.

FAMILY

Xel-Há, Xcaret & Xplor

All-inclusive eco-parks for snorkeling and ziplines. Pricey, but great for kids.

ABOUT

LIGHTHOUSE CHURCH TULUM

We are an English-speaking non-denominational church made up of ordinary people, seeking to serve an extraordinary God. We offer contemporary worship in a casual environment. Visitors are always welcome!

Carretera Tulum–Cobá km 7, Colonia Tankah, Tulum, Q.R.

Find Us on Google Maps | Visit our website

enjoy tulum

We hope this guide helps you make the most of your time here. If you'd like to worship with us while you're in town, you'll find everything you need on our website.